

endlessly creative; others are masters at completing long lists of tasks. Once you dig past that, though, there are some common things that anyone can do, regardless of their financial state, to earn more money.

Get educated

This doesn't mean drop out and go back to school. It merely means to keep learning new things. If something interests you, read a book about it. Take evening classes to get certification in a certain area or get a master's degree. No matter what you're doing, there's some way you can learn more and improve yourself.

More income streams

Always be on the lookout for ways to have money rolling into your pocket from a lot of different places. Maybe you're a good writer and can sell a short story or an online ebook. Maybe you've got a little piece of land somewhere that you can lease to a farmer or a developer. Maybe you spend your free time managing a flower bed in the park—why not put a little wooden freewill donation box out there for people to drop a coin in? Maybe you have some extra cash laying around with which you can buy a long-term treasury note that will keep issuing you a check every six months. Having more in-

come streams merely means that losing one of them (like your job) is less devastating in your life *and* it also means your overall income for now will go up.

Start a side business

Instead of burning a few hours in front of the telly each evening, how about investing at least part of that time into starting a side business? You can try starting a blog with a few ads on it, or maybe you're good with woodworking and can make deck furniture. Maybe you're good at baking bread and can take loaves to the farmer's market, or maybe you deeply enjoy gardening and can sell vegetables. There are lots of possibilities out there for starting a business that will supplement your current income and perhaps eventually grow into your main income.

Move toward your passions

Whenever the opportunity presents itself, gravitate toward the things that really excite you, because passion is what will make you successful. For me, my passion is writing, so I've made an effort to gravitate toward it by working on TheSimpleDollar.com in my spare time. For others, it could be anything—maybe it's leading a team, or perhaps it's writing beautiful computer code. Whatever really